Chen-An Li

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About me

Ph.D. student at National Taiwan University, advised by Prof. Hung-yi Lee. Research focuses on speech retrieval, large audio-language models, and self-supervised speech models.

Education

Ph.D., Communication Engineering 09/2024 – Present
Graduate Institute of Communication Engineering, National Taiwan University (NTU)
Started the M.S. program in 09/2024 and transferred directly to the Ph.D. program in 02/2026.
GPA: **4.3/4.3** | Advisor: Prof. Hung-yi Lee

B.S., Computer Science and Information Engineering 09/2019 – 06/2023
National Taiwan University (NTU)
GPA: **4.0/4.3** | Advisors: Prof. Hung-yi Lee and Prof. Yun-Nung (Vivian) Chen

Research experience

Research Intern, ASUS 06/2023 – 11/2023
Open Cloud Infrastructure Software Center
Studied performance degradation and adaptation dynamics in continual pre-training of aligned large language models.

Research Intern, Academia Sinica 07/2022 – 08/2022
Institute of Information Science | Mentor: Prof. Hsin-Min Wang
Studied the design and performance of automatic speech recognition systems in low-resource settings.

Research Student, NTU 10/2021 – 09/2024
Speech Processing and Machine Learning Laboratory | Mentor: Prof. Hung-yi Lee
Applied self-supervised speech models to prosody, proposed an embedding-fusion ensemble method, and studied vulnerabilities to model extraction attacks.

Research Student, NTU 09/2022 – 07/2023
Machine Intelligence and Understanding Laboratory | Mentor: Prof. Yun-Nung (Vivian) Chen
Developed a framework for visually enhanced language understanding.

Publications

INSPIRE: A Benchmark for Instruction-Aware Speech Retrieval.
Chen-An Li, Hung-yi Lee. Interspeech 2026 (Long Paper)

Hearing the Order: Investigating Position Bias in Large Audio-Language Models.
Yu-Xiang Lin*, **Chen-An Li***, Sheng-Lun Wei, Po-Chun Chen, Hsin-Hsi Chen, Hung-yi Lee. Interspeech 2026

All That Glitters Is Not Audio: Rethinking Text Priors and Audio Reliance in Audio-Language Evaluation.
Leonardo Haw-Yang Foo*, Chih-Kai Yang*, **Chen-An Li**, Ke-Han Lu, Hung-yi Lee. Interspeech 2026

AdaSearch: Balancing Parametric Knowledge and Search in Large Language Models via Reinforcement Learning.
Tzu-Han Lin, Wei-Lin Chen, **Chen-An Li**, Hung-yi Lee, Yun-Nung Chen, Yu Meng. EMNLP 2026

BreezyVoice: Adapting TTS for Taiwanese Mandarin with Enhanced Polyphone Disambiguation—Challenges and Insights.
Chan-Jan Hsu, Yi-Cheng Lin, Chia-Chun Lin, Wei-Chih Chen, Ho Lam Chung, **Chen-An Li**, Yi-Chang Chen et al. ISCSLP 2026

When Silence Matters: The Impact of Irrelevant Audio on Text Reasoning in Large Audio-Language Models.
Chen-An Li, Tzu-Han Lin, Hung-yi Lee. ICASSP 2026

Transferring Textual Preferences to Vision-Language Understanding through Model Merging.
Chen-An Li, Tzu-Han Lin, Yun-Nung Chen, Hung-yi Lee. ACL 2025

Dynamic-SUPERB Phase-2: A Collaboratively Expanding Benchmark for Measuring the Capabilities of Spoken Language Models with 180 Tasks.
Chien-yu Huang, Wei-Chih Chen, Shu-wen Yang, Andy T Liu, **Chen-An Li**, Yu-Xiang Lin et al. ICLR 2025

DogeRM: Equipping Reward Models with Domain Knowledge through Model Merging.
Tzu-Han Lin, **Chen-An Li**, Hung-yi Lee, Yun-Nung Chen. EMNLP 2024

Unsupervised Multilingual Dense Retrieval via Generative Pseudo Labeling.
Chao-Wei Huang, **Chen-An Li**, Tsu-Yuan Hsu, Chen-Yu Hsu, Yun-Nung Chen. Findings of EACL 2024

Visually-Enhanced Phrase Understanding.
Tsu-Yuan Hsu*, **Chen-An Li***, Chao-Wei Huang, Yun-Nung Chen. Findings of ACL 2023

CONVERSER: Few-Shot Conversational Dense Retrieval with Synthetic Data Generation.
Chao-Wei Huang, Chen-Yu Hsu, Tsu-Yuan Hsu, **Chen-An Li**, Yun-Nung Chen. SIGDIAL 2023

Towards General-Purpose Text-Instruction-Guided Voice Conversion.
Chun-Yi Kuan, **Chen-An Li**, Tsu-Yuan Hsu, Tse-Yang Lin, Ho-Lam Chung, Kai-Wei Chang, Shuo-Yiin Chang, Hung-yi Lee. ASRU 2023

On the Utility of Self-Supervised Models for Prosody-Related Tasks.
Guan-Ting Lin*, Chi-Luen Feng*, Wei-Ping Huang**, Yuan Tseng**, Tzu-Han Lin**, **Chen-An Li****, Hung-yi Lee, Nigel G Ward. SLT 2022 (Best Paper Award)

The Efficacy of Self-Supervised Speech Models for Audio Representations.
Tung-Yu Wu*, Tsu-Yuan Hsu*, **Chen-An Li***, Tzu-Han Lin*, Hung-yi Lee. PMLR 2022

Preprints

Improving Large Audio-Language Model Embedding Baselines for Instruction-Aware Speech Retrieval.
Chen-An Li, Cheng-Han Chiang, Hung-yi Lee. arXiv:2611.09122

A Preliminary Exploration with GPT-4o Voice Mode.
Yu-Xiang Lin, Chih-Kai Yang, Wei-Chih Chen, **Chen-An Li**, Chien-yu Huang, Xuanjun Chen, Hung-yi Lee. arXiv:2502.09940

Building a Taiwanese Mandarin Spoken Language Model: A First Attempt.
Chih-Kai Yang, Yu-Kuan Fu, **Chen-An Li**, Yi-Cheng Lin, Yu-Xiang Lin, Wei-Chih Chen, Ho Lam Chung et al. arXiv:2411.07111

Examining Forgetting in Continual Pre-training of Aligned Large Language Models.
Chen-An Li, Hung-yi Lee. arXiv:2401.03129

Improving Cascaded Unsupervised Speech Translation with Denoising Back-Translation.
Yu-Kuan Fu*, Liang-Hsuan Tseng*, Jiatong Shi, **Chen-An Li**, Tsu-Yuan Hsu, Shinji Watanabe, Hung-yi Lee. arXiv:2305.07455

Model Extraction Attack against Self-Supervised Speech Models.
Tsu-Yuan Hsu*, **Chen-An Li***, Tung-Yu Wu, Hung-yi Lee. arXiv:2211.16044

Reviewing

2025 NeurIPS, WWW, Machine Learning, TASLP
2026 ICLR, ICML (Gold Reviewer), ARR (May, August), SLT
2027 ICLR

Teaching and service

System Administrator, NTU 09/2024 – 03/2026
Speech Processing and Machine Learning Laboratory
Managed Slurm high-performance computing infrastructure spanning 5 nodes and over 30 GPUs.

Teaching Assistant, Machine Learning (EE5184), NTU 02/2022 – 06/2022; 02/2025 – 06/2025
Instructor: Prof. Hung-yi Lee
Supported course delivery for 700+ students through assignments, grading, and academic guidance.

Teaching Assistant, Machine Learning (CSIE5043), NTU 09/2021 – 01/2022
Instructor: Prof. Hsuan-Tien Lin
Supported course delivery for 300+ students through assignment design, grading, and academic guidance.

Skills

Programming and tools: C/C++, Python, shell scripting, Linux, Slurm, Git, Emacs
Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent)